

#### **Fourth Suit Forcing   New Minor Forcing   Help Suit Game Try**

**FSF** : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

**NMF** : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

**HSGT** : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠K

Board: 2

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣6

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♥2

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 2♦

Declarer: West

Lead: ♣K

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 3 2

♥ J 8

♦ A K 9 6 4 2

♣ 3

♠ A 6 4

♥ A K 9 7 2

♦ 7

♣ K 8 6 5



♠ K Q J 10

♥ 10 4

♦ Q J 5

♣ Q 10 9 4

♠ 9 7

♥ Q 6 5 3

♦ 10 8 3

♣ A J 7 2

NORTH could make a Help Suit Game Try in either ♠s or ♣s. But she doesn't need the ♠ help as much as she does in ♣s, so she chooses ♣s.

SOUTH doesn't have a strong hand but has excellent help in ♣s so he bids the game.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

3 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ K

**Board 2**

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 10 5

♥ 10 9 6

♦ K 7

♣ A Q J 3

♠ 4 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ Q J 10 6 3

♣ 10 7 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 6

♥ K J 8 5

♦ A 9 8 5 4

♣ K 8

♠ A 9 8 7 2

♥ Q 7 3

♦ 2

♣ 9 6 5 2

Could EAST bid 2♥, (FSF), even though she actually has the suit?

Perhaps, but there is no reason to do so. WEST does not have four ♥s or he would have mentioned them before bidding ♠s.

EAST should ignore the ♥ suit and bid 3NT.

*West*

1♣

*North*

Pass

*East*

1♦

*South*

Pass

1♠

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

Lead: ♣6

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 2  
♥ J 3 2  
♦ J 5 4 2  
♣ K J 10 3

♠ Q 5 4

♥ 7 6

♦ A K 9 8

♣ A 8 7 4



♠ 9 8 7

♥ A 10 4

♦ Q 10 7

♣ Q 9 6 2

♠ A K 10 6 3

♥ K Q 9 8 5

♦ 6 3

♣ 5

SOUTH cannot bid 2♥ at his second turn; that would be Fourth Suit Forcing and wouldn't show the ♥ suit at all.

With a game-forcing two-suiter he jumps to 3♥ instead. NORTH recognizes that SOUTH must hold five ♠s and bids the ♠ game.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1♦    | Pass | 1♠    |
| Pass        | 2♣    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥2    |       |      |       |

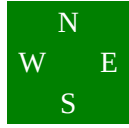
**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8 5  
 ♥ A 5  
 ♦ K Q J 6 2  
 ♣ 6 4 3

♠ A 9 4 3  
 ♥ 9 4  
 ♦ 8 7  
 ♣ K Q J 8 5



♠ K 7 6  
 ♥ K J 8 7 3  
 ♦ A 9 4  
 ♣ 9 2

♠ J 10 2  
 ♥ Q 10 6 2  
 ♦ 10 5 3  
 ♣ A 10 7

EAST bids 2♣ as New Minor Forcing, hoping WEST has three ♥s.

WEST does not have three ♥s and he has no other bid to make that will describe his hand any better. He cannot bid Notrump again without a ♣ stopper. So WEST rebids the 5-card ♦ suit.

EAST has nowhere to go, so passes.

| <i>West</i> | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|-------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
| 1♦          | Pass         | 1♥          | Pass         |
| 1NT         | Pass         | 2♣          | Pass         |
| 2♦          |              |             |              |
| All Pass    |              |             |              |
| 2♦ by West  |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♣K    |              |             |              |